Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Recording an exhibition: three visual moments

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 6 Part 1 · Big question: How do we capture rapid observational sketches, spatial notes, and lighting analyses from curated artworks?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: When making a 6-minute field sketch in front of an exhibited artwork, what should you prioritise?

Correct: Capturing the core structural proportions, the darkest shadow shapes, and the brightest light edges using confident shorthand marks — Exactly! Lock in the big geometry and the highest-contrast values first.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: Why do we move between exhibition stations calmly with clipboards held close to our chest? -> To protect the exhibited artworks and directional lighting rigs while giving every observer a clear sightline (Correct. Professional gallery etiquette keeps the artworks and viewers safe.)

Q2: What is the best way to record a complex texture (like corrugated ridges or stippled wash) in a fast 6-minute field sketch? -> Draw a dense patch of accurate shorthand texture in the focal zone and add a pointer note describing the rest

(Spot on! That classic architectural sketching trick captures exact detail without running out of time.)

Q3: What should you write in your 'Critical impact' zone before leaving each station? -> How the combination of material craft and curatorial lighting made the work feel (e.g. 'Monolithic and dramatic due to deep undercut shadows') (Yes! Linking technical evidence to visual impact gives you the exact thesis for your Week 7 review.)

Exit check answer

Question: When making a timed field sketch of a textured artwork in an exhibition, how do you record complex surface grain efficiently?

Correct: Render a focused patch of accurate texture in the key zone and pair it with an analytical pointer note — Correct. Focused rendering plus clear annotation is how professional designers record field studies.